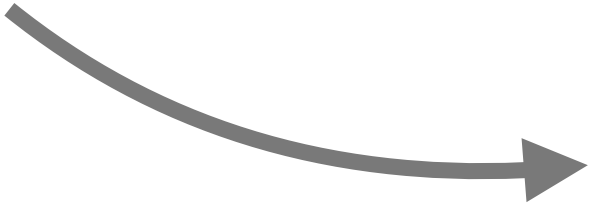


The fact that there are
contingent things can't
be explained by any
contingent thing.





The fact that there are
contingent things is
contingent.

Every contingent fact
has an explanation.

The fact that there
are contingent
things is explained
by some thing which
is not contingent.





The fact that there
are contingent things
has an explanation.

The fact that there
are contingent
things is explained
by a necessary
being.

There is a necessary being
that explains the existence
of contingent things.







Leibniz's
argument



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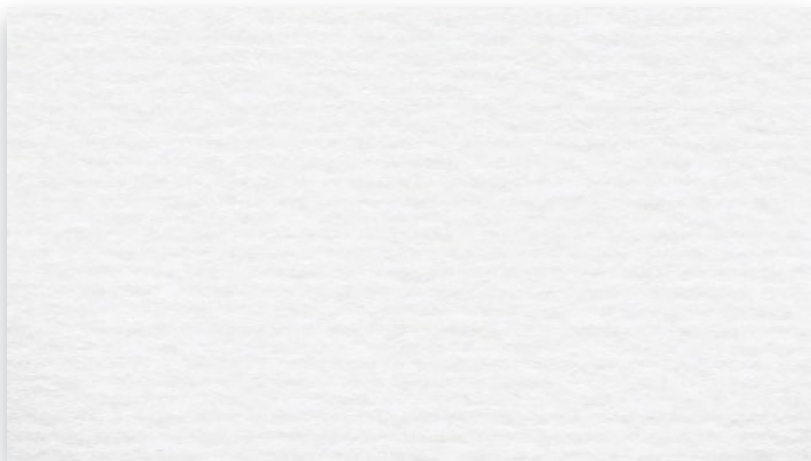
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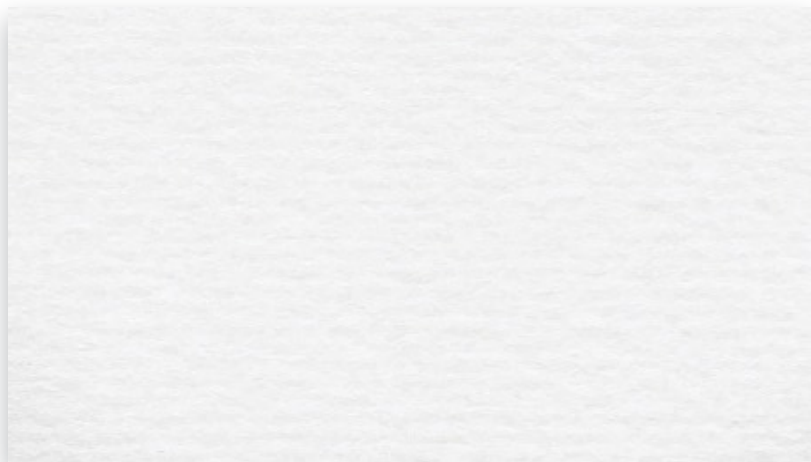












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A pixelated, grayscale uppercase letter 'C'. The letter is composed of dark gray pixels with a lighter gray, noisy border, giving it a retro, digital appearance.A pixelated, grayscale uppercase letter 'B'. The letter is composed of dark gray pixels with a lighter gray, noisy border, giving it a retro, digital appearance.A pixelated, grayscale lowercase letter 'u'. The letter is composed of dark gray pixels with a lighter gray, noisy border, giving it a retro, digital appearance.A pixelated, grayscale uppercase letter 'E'. The letter is composed of dark gray pixels with a lighter gray, noisy border, giving it a retro, digital appearance.A pixelated, grayscale uppercase letter 'B'. The letter is composed of dark gray pixels with a lighter gray, noisy border, giving it a retro, digital appearance.

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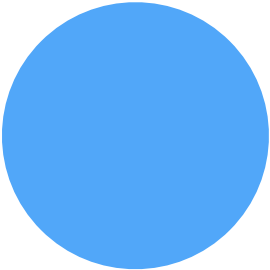


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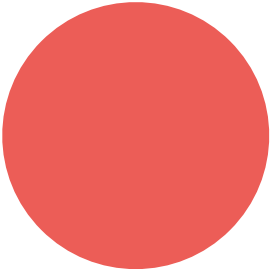












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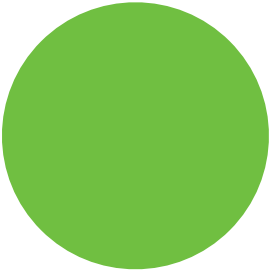
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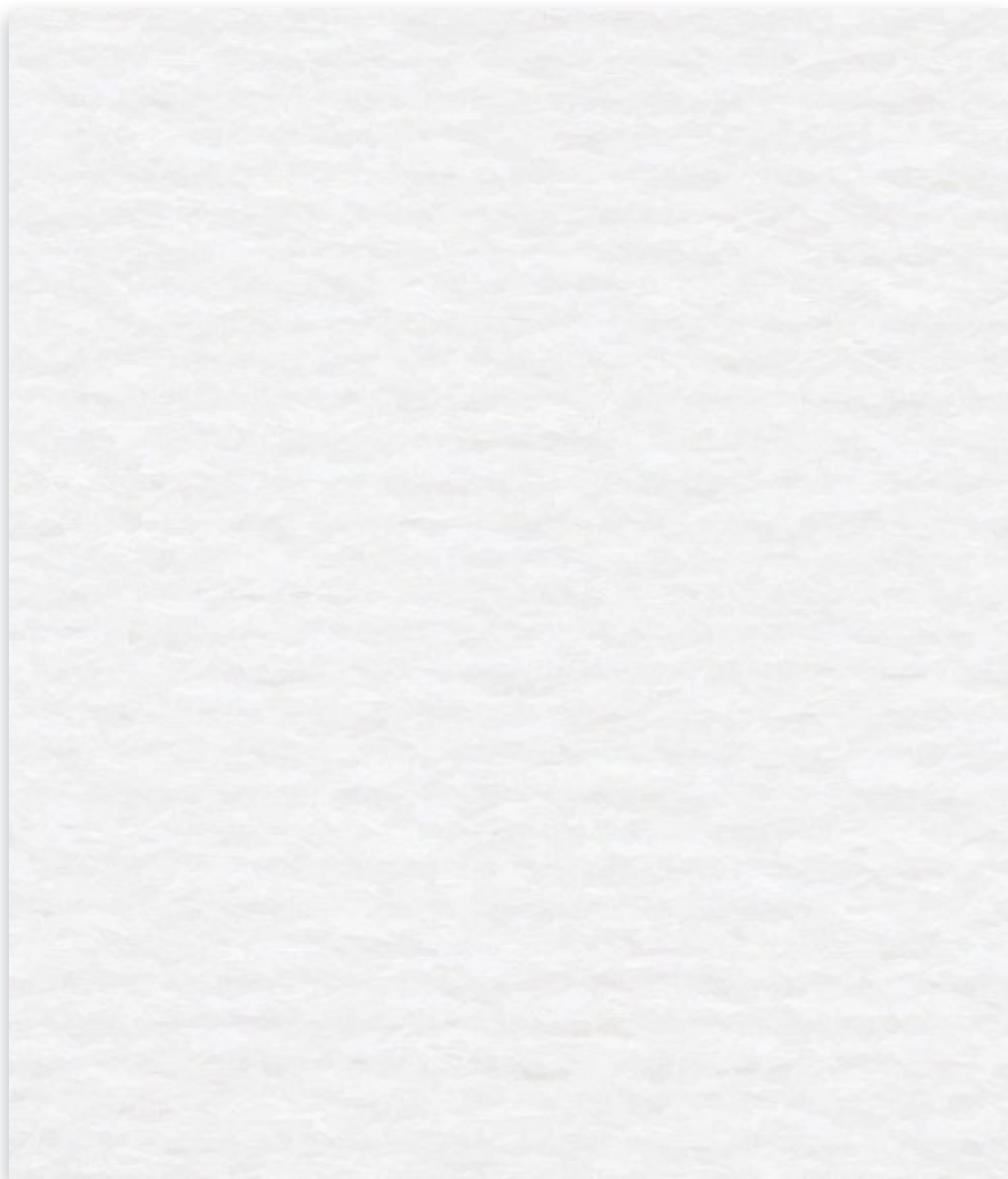
... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



Leibniz's
argument







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